

Title

Adjunctive Individualized Cognitive-Behavioral Therapy Substantially Improves Psychological and Sleep Outcomes in Fibromyalgia

Abstract

Seventy participants with fibromyalgia were randomized to receive 10 weeks of individualized cognitive-behavioral therapy combined with routine treatment (n = 35) or routine treatment alone (n = 34). Fifty-seven participants completed the study protocol. At endpoint, the cognitive-behavioral therapy group demonstrated significant improvements across all measured domains compared to controls. Anxiety scores (Hospital Anxiety and Depression Scale-anxiety subscale) declined from median 13 to 10 points in the intervention group versus 13 to 12 in controls (p = 0.008). Depression scores similarly improved (13 to 9 versus 13 to 11, p = 0.006). Jenkins Sleep Scale scores showed greater benefit in the intervention arm (p = 0.002). Disease-specific functional impairment (Fibromyalgia Impact Questionnaire) declined from median 64 to 48 in the cognitive-behavioral therapy group compared to 63 to 58 in controls (p = 0.003). Beck Hopelessness Scale scores decreased more substantially with combined intervention (p = 0.009). These findings support integration of individualized psychological intervention into fibromyalgia treatment pathways.